Little Fox Readers

Level 5

Journey to the West 52

An Ocean from a Vase



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Little Fox

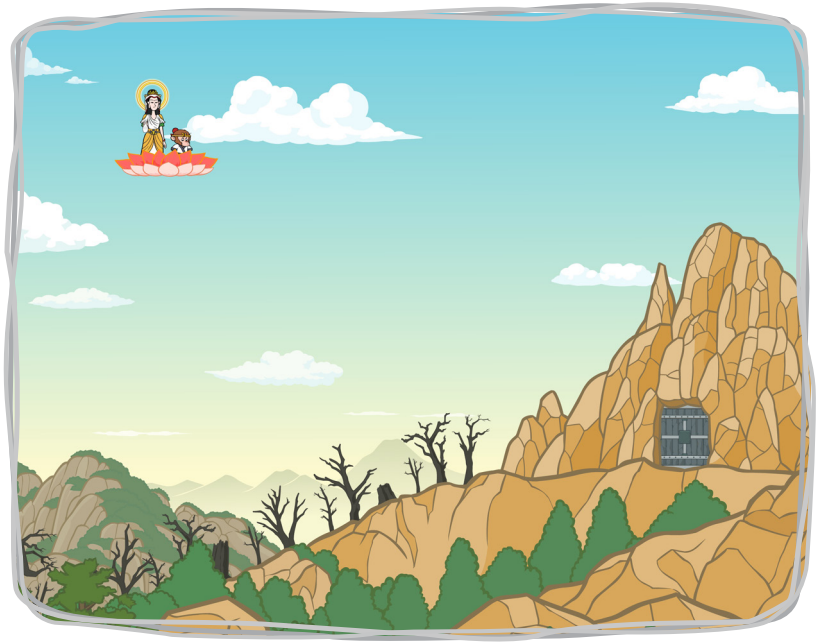
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Wukong and Guanyin stood on the lotus platform above Red Boy's mountain.

"Let's attack Red Boy now," said the monkey.

"Wait, Wukong," said Guanyin, holding up a hand. "There's a lot of water in this vase—enough for an ocean. I don't want any animals harmed when I pour it out." She recited a quick spell.



A moment later the local spirit arrived. "Bodhisattva," said the spirit. "What can I do for you?"

"I'm going to pour magic water around Red Boy's mountain," said Guanyin. "Please make sure all the animals are far, far away from the mountain."

"Yes, Bodhisattva," said the spirit.

The spirit flew down to earth. Wukong



watched the ground below. First he saw some small animals scurry out from under bushes. Birds flew from branches. Then tigers, bears, and other large animals stampeded down the mountainside. Soon there wasn't a single animal anywhere near the mountain.

"Now I can pour the water out," said Guanyin.

She tipped the vase, and rolling waves of



water poured out. The waves washed down the slopes of the mountain. The water level rose higher and higher, forming an ocean. Only the top of the mountain was above water.

"Wukong, go down there and get the demon to come out," said Guanyin. "Fight him, but don't defeat him. Instead, lead him up here to me."



Wukong jumped down to the mountain. He pulled out his iron bar and swung it. *Smash!* The door to the cave exploded.

Red Boy ran out of the cave, looking furious. "You smashed my front door!" he shouted.

"That's right," said the monkey. "And I'll smash *you* if you don't release my friends."

"Ha!" Red Boy laughed and then punched



himself in the nose. Nothing happened.

"Why didn't my fire magic work?" asked the demon. Then he noticed the ocean surrounding his mountain.

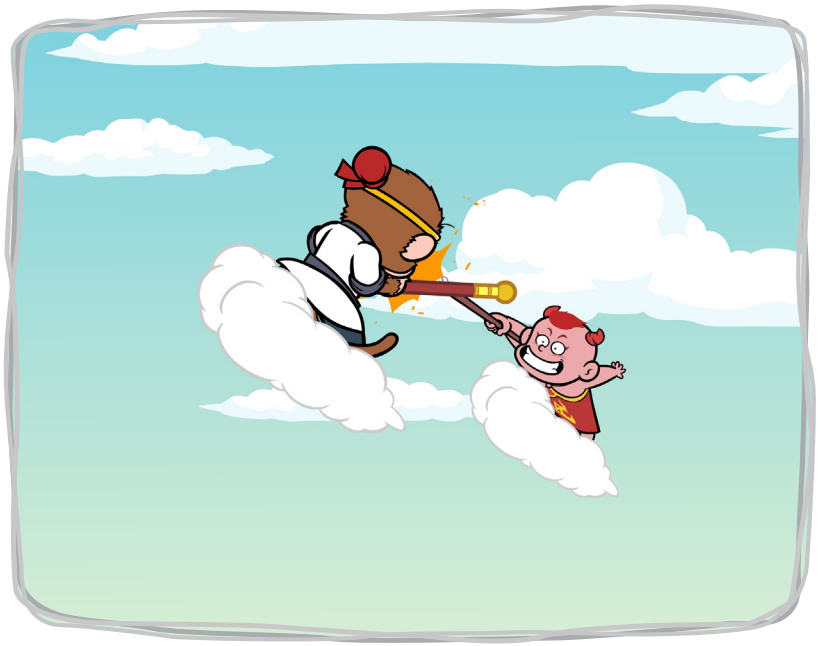
Wukong laughed. "That is magic water, brought here by the bodhisattva Guanyin. You can't make fire anywhere near it."

"Aargh!" Red Boy stabbed at Wukong with his lance.



Clang! The monkey blocked the lance with his iron bar. Red Boy grunted and stabbed again. Wukong swung his iron bar, nearly knocking the lance from Red Boy's hands.

The two fought until Wukong, pretending to be scared, leaped into the air. Red Boy followed. Up into the sky they flew. Red Boy kept jabbing his lance at Wukong. The



monkey blocked it with his iron bar.

Wukong hurried toward Guanyin on the lotus platform. He flew fast and ducked behind her.

When Red Boy saw the bodhisattva, he stopped. "What are you doing here, Bodhisattva?" he demanded.

Guanyin stared back at the demon. But she didn't say a word.

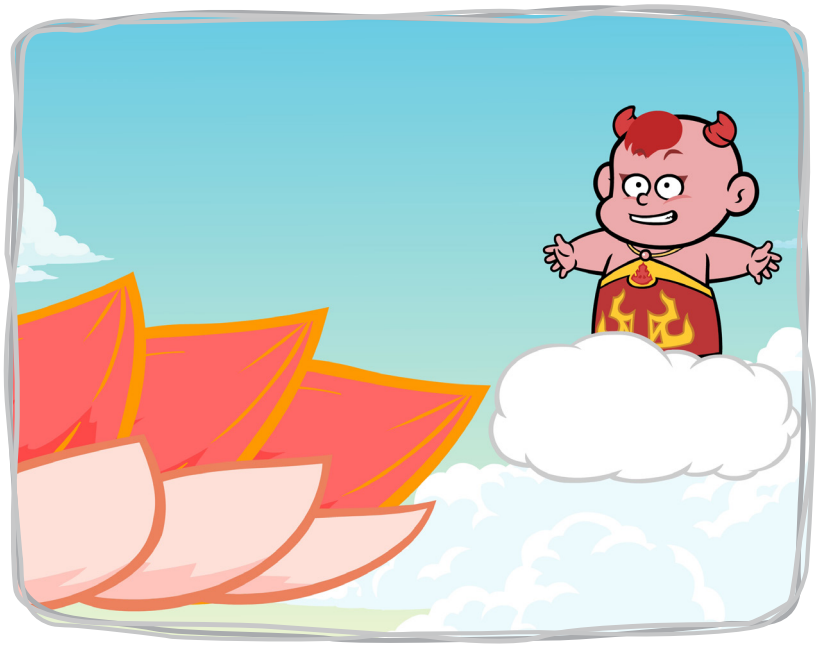


"I asked why you're here!" shouted Red Boy.

Again Guanyin didn't answer.

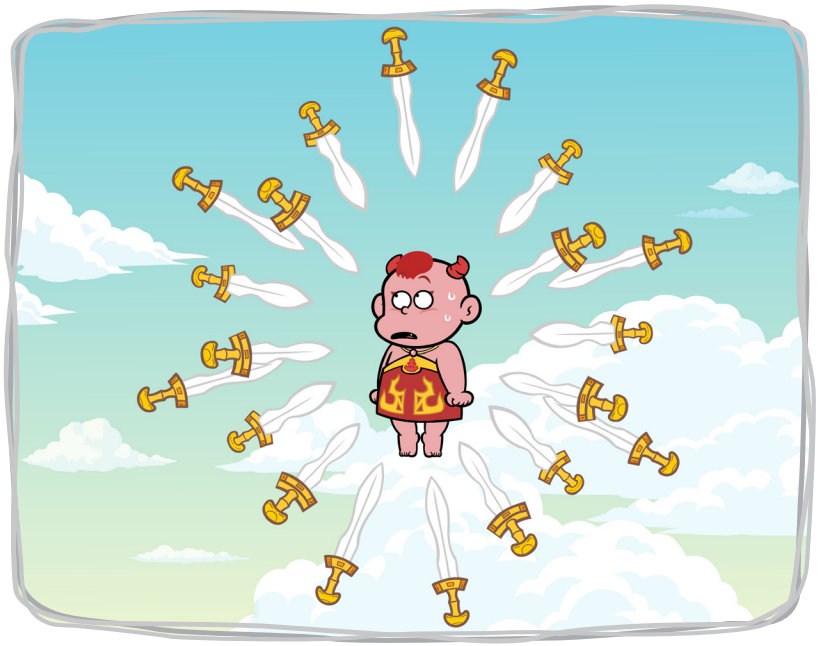
"Did Wukong ask you to come here?" shouted the demon. "Why don't you speak?"

Guanyin continued to stare silently at Red Boy. The demon became furious. He raised his lance and shot toward Guanyin. The bodhisattva vanished!



Red Boy laughed. "I guess she was scared of me." He looked at the empty lotus platform. "Wukong is a fool! He couldn't defeat my fire magic, so he asked Guanyin for help. And what did she do? She ran away as soon as I raised my weapon. Now this Buddhist treasure is mine!"

Red Boy sat down on the platform. Instantly the platform turned back into



swords, which surrounded the demon. Sharp points stuck at him on all sides.

"Oh no!" cried Red Boy. "I'm trapped!"